

Visualising the Response Time of a Web Server Using Wireshark

The versatile Wireshark tool can be put to several uses. This article presents a tutorial on using Wireshark to discover and visualise the response time of a Web server.



Wireshark is a cross-platform network analysis tool used to capture packets in real-time. Wireshark includes filters, flow statistics, colour coding, and other features that allow you to get a deep insight into network traffic and to inspect individual packets. Discovering the delayed HTTP responses for a particular HTTP request from a particular PC is a tedious task for most admins. This tutorial will teach readers how to discover and visualise the response time of a Web server using Wireshark. *OSFY* has published many articles on Wireshark, which you can refer to for a better understanding of the topic.

Step 1: Start capturing the packets using Wireshark on a specified interface to which you are connected. Refer to the

bounding box in Figure 1 for available interfaces.

In this tutorial, we are going to capture Wi-Fi packets, so the option 'Wi-Fi' has been selected (if you wish to capture the packets using Ethernet or any other interface, select the corresponding options).

Step 2: Here, we make a request to <http://www.wikipedia.org> and, as a result, Wikipedia sends an HTTP response of '200 OK', which indicates the requested action was successful. '200 OK' implies that the response contains a payload, which represents the status of the requested resource (the request is successful). Now filter all the HTTP packets as shown in Figure 2, as follows:

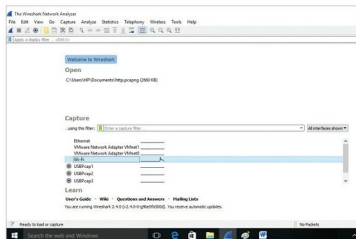


Figure 1: Interface selection

syntax: http

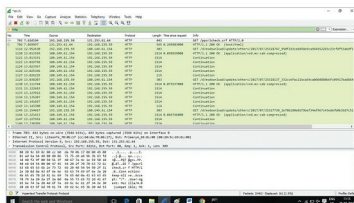


Figure 2: Filtering HTTP